

Right The “old town” quarter of Patershol offers some of the best options for eating and drinking in Ghent

Below Creamy-white *waterzooi* fish stew includes delicate spices traded in Ghent since the Middle Ages



A Day in Ghent

All the main sights are within easy walking distance of the historic downtown, but the main art museums are in the Citadelpark in the south of the city, a tram-ride away.

MORNING Start with **St-Baafskathedraal** and a pilgrimage to Jan van Eyck's glorious painting, *The Adoration of the Mystic Lamb*. A short walk past the **Belfort** (belfry) and Gothic **St-Niklaaskerk** will lead you to the **Graslei** and **Korenlei**, where medieval and Renaissance guildhouses line the old river port. The **Groot Vleeshuis**, a medieval butcher's hall, showcases regional food specialties.

AFTERNOON Head for the cutting-edge museum of contemporary art, **SMAK**, or the nearby **Museum voor Schone Kunsten**, which has an impressive collection of pre-20th-century art.

EVENING For tickets at the **Vlaamse Opera** in the evening, you have to book well in advance; if this is impossible, head back to the old downtown for a stroll in **Patershol** district and a supper of *waterzooi*.

Essentials

GETTING THERE

The nearest **international airport** is Brussels (Zaventem), 37 miles (60 km) away. Ghent's main **train** station, Sint-Pieters, is near the Citadelpark, a tram-ride from downtown. The city has an excellent **tram** and **bus** network.

WHERE TO STAY

Flandria (inexpensive) is a small, family-oriented central hotel. www.hotelflandria-gent.be
Erasmus (moderate) is a delightful small hotel in a 16th-century house filled with antiques. www.erasmushotel.be

NH Gent Belfort (expensive) offers elegant, international-style comfort downtown.

www.nh-hotels.com

TOURIST INFORMATION

www.visitgent.be

